

Literary Devices

Below are 12 tools used by authors to help show readers what is important. For each tool, write down one example from a movie, song, or book you already know. If you're stuck, leave it blank and we'll discuss it in class!

Device	Short definition	Your example
Theme	A 'Big Idea' or lesson	
Motif	A recurring symbol or pattern.	
Symbol	Something that represents another idea	
Metaphor	Comparison without 'like' or 'as'	
Simile	Comparison using 'like' or 'as'	
Allusion	An implied 'shout-out' to another source (book, movie, etc.)	
Personification	Giving human traits to non-humans	
Paradox	Conflicting ideas that seem impossible but are true	
Foil	Two characters who are similar yet opposite in an important way	
Imagery	Decription that uses 1 or more of the 5 senses	
Tone	The author's attitude toward the subject	
Mood	The 'vibe' or feeling the reader gets	